

DOCUMENT CONTROL

# Temporary Risk Acceptance Request — SLA Uptime

Formal waiver for pilot-phase uptime risk pending commercial renegotiation.

|                 |                          |
|-----------------|--------------------------|
| Document ID     | EXC-001                  |
| Owner           | Vendor Management        |
| Request Date    | 2024-03-15               |
| Approval Status | Approved with conditions |
| Expiry          | 2024-06-30               |

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## Requested Exception

Meridian requests temporary acceptance of the current **99.5% monthly uptime** commitment in the Northwind Cloud Infrastructure SLA for the pilot window ending 2024-06-30. This exception is limited to availability targets and does not waive unresolved liability or privacy issues.

## Business Justification

- Pilot launch timing depends on the Northwind managed retrieval platform becoming available before the Q2 executive rollout.
- Re-platforming to an alternative vendor within the current quarter would materially delay the internal AI search program.
- The current service architecture includes compensating controls that reduce user-visible impact of isolated outages.

## Compensating Controls

| Control                                         | Owner                | Review Cadence |
|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------|----------------|
| Dual-run fallback search path                   | Platform Engineering | Weekly         |
| Monthly service report review and escalation    | Vendor Management    | Monthly        |
| Executive checkpoint on revised SLA negotiation | Maria Santos         | Bi-weekly      |

## Approvals

| Role                               | Name         | Status / Date                         |
|------------------------------------|--------------|---------------------------------------|
| VP, Procurement                    | Maria Santos | Approved — 2024-03-15                 |
| Chief Information Security Officer | Elena Petrov | Approved with conditions — 2024-03-15 |
| Chief Operating Officer            | Samuel Reed  | Approved — 2024-03-16                 |